

History

Teaching and Learning Syllabus

Grades 3 to 6



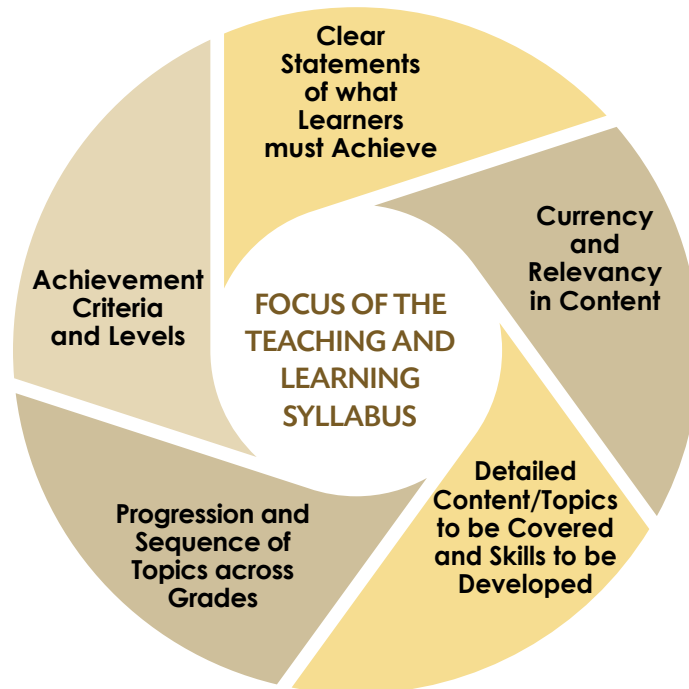
Mauritius Institute of Education
under the aegis of
Ministry of Education and Human Resources, Tertiary Education and Scientific Research



Teaching and Learning Syllabus History

The Teaching and Learning Syllabus refers to the content of what is to be taught, and to the knowledge, skills, competencies, attitudes and values that are to be developed. It articulates concisely the specific learning outcomes for each grade as per the NCF 2015 and features achievable learning outcomes that represent a Teaching and Learning road map.

- **The focus of the TLS**



- **Clear statements of what learners must achieve**

The TLS spells out the specific learning outcomes that learners are expected to achieve progressively in terms of knowledge, understanding, skills, 21st Century Competencies, attitudes and values during each year of schooling, from Grades 1 to 6.

- **Currency and relevancy in content**

The TLS ensures currency and relevance of content and acquisition of developmentally-appropriate concepts and skills.

- **Detailed content/topics to be covered and skills to be developed**

The TLS details the content and topics to be covered as well as the skills to be developed for each grade while addressing the problem of curriculum overload and stress.

- **Progression and sequence of topics across grades**

The TLS outlines the scope and sequence of the specific learning outcomes for each grade. It indicates the grade in which knowledge, concepts, skills and processes related to the learning outcomes are introduced, based on a spiral curriculum. The learning outcomes are progressively sequenced across grades.

- **Achievement criteria and levels**

The TLS defines assessment criteria that are scaffolded and represent clear measurable outcomes. The levels reflect the competencies in terms of knowledge, skills, values and attitudes expected to have been acquired by learners. The development of achievement levels are meant to assist in the differentiation of teaching, learning and assessment so that the curriculum is accessible to all learners.

Contents

Rationale	5
Expected Learning Outcomes for History	5
The Development of 21st Century Competencies and History	6
Scope and Sequence of Content Areas for History	7
Content Areas and Specific Learning Outcomes of History for Grade 3	9
Content Areas and Specific Learning Outcomes of History for Grade 4	10
Content Areas and Specific Learning Outcomes of History for Grade 5	11
Content Areas and Specific Learning Outcomes of History for Grade 6	12
Achievement Criteria and Levels	13
Learning Outcomes, Achievement Criteria and Levels for Grades 3, 4, 5 and 6	13



RATIONALE

The History teaching and learning syllabus is a document that is an outcome of a series of consultative meetings held with different stakeholders involved in the education sector. The document spells out in detail the knowledge and skills learners should acquire at the end of primary schooling. It also focuses on the development of historical inquiry in learners and deviates from the traditional approach to teaching and assessing History, which lays much emphasis on rote learning and memorization of facts. Rather the stress is on the development of inquiry skills, positive attitude, respect for different cultures and heritage, and a sense of belonging to the nation. Furthermore, the development of critical thinking and communication skills, considered to be key skills in the 21st century teaching and learning, constitutes an important aspect of this document. As such, the syllabus makes provision for promoting oral and written skills through discussing historical questions and presenting findings. The syllabus further highlights the specific learning outcomes, competencies and achievement levels for all content areas at each grade of primary schooling, thus serving as a guideline for educators, curriculum developers and other stakeholders.

EXPECTED LEARNING OUTCOMES FOR HISTORY

By the end of Grade 6, learners should be able to:

- Show interest in finding out about the past
- Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of people and events in the past
- Use a range of historical evidence to understand the past and present
- Develop and use inquiry skills in exploring events in the past
- Demonstrate an appreciation of the interdependence of people and the environment
- Communicate historical understanding using appropriate vocabulary
- Demonstrate an appreciation of their cultural and historical heritage
- Demonstrate an awareness of the importance of preserving their historical heritage
- Develop a sense of belonging to the country.

THE DEVELOPMENT OF 21ST CENTURY COMPETENCIES AND HISTORY

In line with the NCF, which outlines a set of 21st century competencies to be developed and attained in a progressive and consistent way by all learners, the History curriculum embodies an interrelated approach to teaching content and developing inquiry skills and competencies. Without skills, students would be left to memorize facts and recall details leading to passive learning. The ability to think, speak and write logically, to solve problems and to synthesize information are key competencies that History teaching aims to develop in the learners.

Teaching and learning of History in the 21st century also means that students should master content while producing, synthesizing, and evaluating information from a wide variety of sources with an understanding of and respect for diverse cultures. The History curriculum lays emphasis on teaching through real examples, application and experiences both inside and outside of school. Fieldwork and visits to historical sites provide learners with opportunities to engage with real life examples. Students understand and retain more when their learning is concrete, relevant, engaging and meaningful to their lives. Students demonstrate not only the three Rs, but also the three Cs: creativity, communication, and collaboration. They also demonstrate digital literacy as well as civic responsibility.

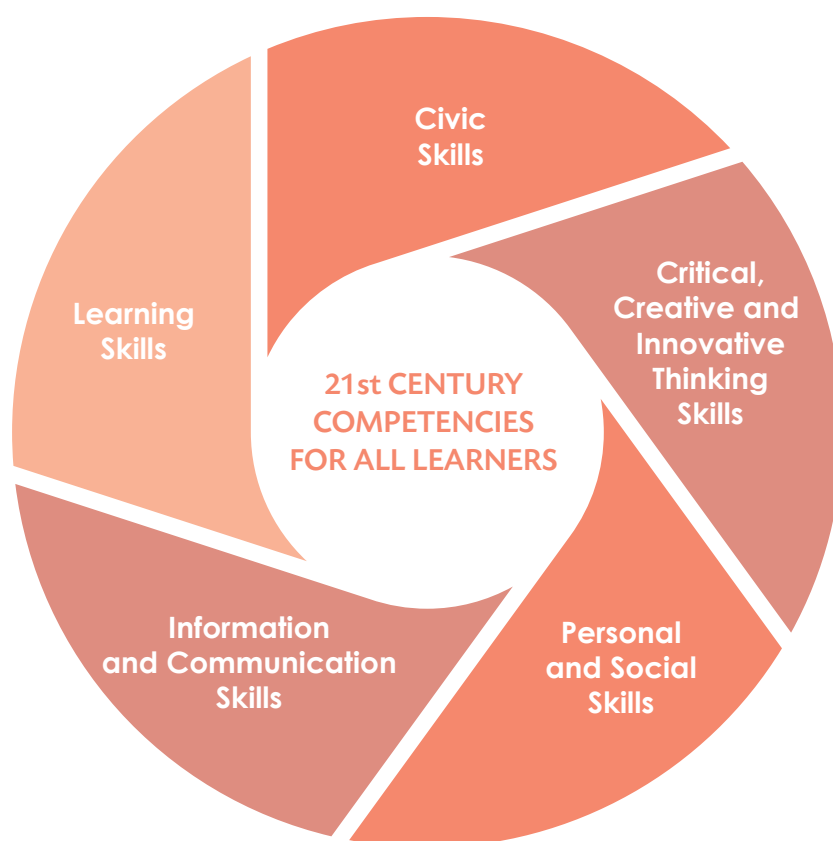


Figure 1: 21st Century Competencies for All Learners

SCOPE AND SEQUENCE OF CONTENT AREAS FOR HISTORY

The History Curriculum is organized around two interrelated components:

(i) Historical Knowledge & Understanding, and (ii) Historical Skills.

A third important dimension of the present History Curriculum is the development of Historical Inquiry in learners.

- Historical Knowledge and Understanding

This component includes themes of personal, family, local, and national history. Emphasis is laid on the History of Mauritius in Grades V & VI. This strand includes a study of societies, events and developments that have shaped the island's history from the time of its discovery to the present day. It explores key concepts for developing historical understanding, such as: evidence, continuity and change, cause and effect, significance, perspectives and empathy. These concepts are investigated within a particular historical context to facilitate an understanding of the past and to provide a focus for historical inquiries.

- Historical Inquiry

A new element of the present History syllabus is the focus on developing inquiry skills. As such the content across the different grades is designed to encourage learners to ask questions, reflect on the context, interpret sources and communicate effectively. Learners are provided with opportunities through the selected themes to involve themselves in the 5Es of Historical inquiry: Engage, Explore, Explain, Elaborate and Evaluate.

- Historical Skills

This component promotes skills used in the process of historical inquiry. Within this strand, emphasis is laid on historical interpretation and the use of evidence. The syllabus is organized to promote the development of skills in learners at all grades in relation to the content in order to make learning meaningful. Further, the content prescribed allows for the practice and reinforcement of skills.

Relationship between the strands

(Historical Knowledge and understanding, Historical Skills and Historical Inquiry)

The three strands are integrated in the teaching and learning program. The Historical Knowledge and Understanding strand provides the contexts through which historical inquiry and historical skills are to be developed.

Content Areas	Grade Levels			
	3	4	5	6
Historical Knowledge and Understanding				
Myself & My Family	•			
My Locality	•	•		
Voyages of Discovery		•		
Discovery of Mauritius & Rodrigues			•	
Settlement in Mauritius & Rodrigues			•	
Port Louis: the Capital of Mauritius			•	
People on the island in the Past: Settlers, Slaves & Immigrants				•
Celebrating Independence				•
Our Cultural Heritage	•	•	•	•
Historical Inquiry				
Engage: observe and question - identify and reflect on the current understanding of a topic/issue/problem - investigate and determine questions to ask - begin with a plan of enquiry	•	•	•	•
Explore: collect, record and present information - locate sources of information - collect primary historical sources of information (photographs, artefacts, images, documents, among others) - secondary historical sources of information (textbook and others) - record and present information using a variety of formats (diagrams, figures, pictures, quotes).	•	•	•	•
Explain: understand, think and communicate - understand concepts not clear - share and discuss information	•	•	•	•
Elaborate: analyse and make wider connections - link information gathered from a range of sources. - make sense of the information - make connections between events	•	•	•	•
Evaluate: assess, reflect and respond - reflect on the findings (what has been learnt, conclusion drawn) - combine prior understanding with the event/findings - answer the questions asked	•	•	•	•
Historical Skills				
Chronological understanding • place events in chronological order (sequencing events) • use words and phrases relating to the passing of time (for example, before, after, a long time ago...)	•	•	•	•
Knowledge and understanding of events, people and changes in the past • find from sources why people did things, why events happened and their consequences • identify similarities and differences between ways of life at different times (Past & Present)	•	•	•	•
Historical interpretation • identify different ways in which the past is represented.	•	•	•	•
Historical enquiry • ask and answer questions about the past • find about the past from a range of sources of information (for example, stories, pictures and photographs, artefacts, historic buildings and visits to museums, the use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT-based sources).	•	•	•	•
Communication • communicate information in a variety of ways (for example, talking, writing, using ICT)	•	•	•	•

CONTENT AREAS AND SPECIFIC LEARNING OUTCOMES OF HISTORY FOR GRADE 3

Content Area	Topics	By the end of Grade 3, learners should be able to:
Historical Knowledge and Understanding Historical Inquiry* Historical Skills*	Myself & My Family My Locality	• Show basic understanding of past and present - recall and list in sequential manner significant personal events and dates related to themselves (my age, when I was born, first day at school) (concept: chronology) - develop vocabulary related to time (e.g. today, long ago) • Show awareness of time and change - compare photographs, clothes worn or toys used noting development and things which have stayed the same (concept: change, continuity and development) - construct simple timeline related to themselves - identify members of the family and compare relative ages - discuss and record significant family events - explore and discuss how family members care for each other - draw their own family tree • Show an awareness of space, time, change and development - identify and name buildings, monuments and places of worship in the locality (school & their own locality) - identify old and new objects (concept: change and development) - identify changes in locality (e.g. Houses, means of transport, leisure activity) (concept: change) • develop respect for self, others and the environment - develop awareness that certain buildings in the locality should be preserved and protected • develop communication skills - listen, retell & record through pictures simple stories of people in the past and in the present in the locality (sequencing & communication skills)
*The content provides opportunities to develop in learners historical inquiry and historical skills. Values, attitudes, respect for cultural heritage and civic responsibility are addressed in conjunction with relevant Historical themes.		

CONTENT AREAS AND SPECIFIC LEARNING OUTCOMES OF HISTORY FOR GRADE 4

Content Area	Topic	By the end of Grade 4, learners should be able to:
Historical Knowledge and Understanding	Locality: Past & Present	• Develop an understanding of change and continuity by exploring similarities and differences between past and present - identify and name different types of locality (urban, rural and coastal) - explore and become aware of elements in the local environment which show continuity and change (buildings - houses, monuments, places of worship - means of transport...) • Develop ability to use evidence to understand the past - examine photographs, drawings, objects and simple accounts of places and events in the past with the present. - compare pictures of buildings and objects, old/new, their purpose and historical importance
Historical Inquiry*	People living in the Locality - Past & Present: Our Community	• Develop an understanding of time and chronology - compare lives of people in the past with the lives of people today, noting differences and similarities (their homes, work they did, their clothes, how they travelled, games and leisure activities) - record information about people and events in the past using simple timeline • Demonstrate an appreciation of our cultural diversity (e.g. food, clothing and ways of life) - show awareness and respect for people from different social, cultural and religious backgrounds living in the country - discuss the traditions and celebration of common festivals in the country
Historical Skills*	Voyages of Discovery	• Realize how Mauritius and Rodrigues were before the arrival of human beings - name and locate on a map countries on a map trading in the Indian Ocean in the past - give reasons why people travelled in the Indian Ocean - name plants and animals that existed on our island in the past - name, locate and mark nature reserves on a map - recognize importance of plants and animals and their preservation.

*The content provides opportunities to develop in learners historical inquiry and historical skills. Values, attitudes, respect for cultural heritage and civic responsibility are addressed in conjunction with relevant Historical themes.

CONTENT AREAS AND SPECIFIC LEARNING OUTCOMES OF HISTORY FOR GRADE 5

Content Area	Topics	By the end of Grade 5, learners should be able to:
Historical Knowledge and Understanding	Discovery of Mauritius & Rodrigues	• Show an understanding of how Mauritius was when discovered - show on a map the route taken by the Europeans to reach India and the East Indies - name and find information from relevant sources about a few explorers in the 15th century - describe the fauna and flora of the island in the 16th century - explain the discovery of the Mascarene Islands
Historical Inquiry*	Settlement in Mauritius & Rodrigues	• Beginning of Settlement in Mauritius & Rodrigues - discuss reasons for making settlement on the island by the Dutch, French and the British respectively - examine the changes brought in the island due to the settlement by Europeans
Historical Skills*	Port Louis : the Capital of Mauritius	• Activities of Settlers: Trade and Agriculture - discuss the activities of the settlers on the island (agriculture : crops grown; trade: goods traded, infrastructure: roads built, development in the means of communication) - appreciate the contributions of a few personalities in the development of the island (Labourdonnais, Pierre Poivre, Decaen, Sir Robert Farquhar) • Examine the importance of Port Louis in the history of the country - identify and name a few buildings in Port Louis - describe the purpose of the buildings - explain how the harbour of Port Louis was developed by the French - assess the importance of Port Louis as the trading and commercial centre of the island in the past and present.

*The content provides opportunities to develop in learners historical inquiry and historical skills. Values, attitudes, respect for cultural heritage and civic responsibility are addressed in conjunction with relevant Historical themes.

CONTENT AREAS AND SPECIFIC LEARNING OUTCOMES OF HISTORY FOR GRADE 6

Content Area	Topics	By the end of Grade 6, learners should be able to:
Historical Knowledge and Understanding	People on the island in the Past: Settlers, Slaves & Immigrants	• Develop an understanding of the social and cultural life of the people on the island before independence - identify and locate on the map places from where the settlers, slaves and immigrants (Indian & Chinese) came to the island - describe the life and works of the slaves and the Indian indentured labourers on the island - discuss the contribution of slaves and the Indian indentured labourers in the development of the island - examine the role of the Chinese immigrants in the country - discuss the social and cultural life of the people during the Dutch, French and the British rule
Historical Inquiry*	Celebrating Independence	• Appreciate the significance of the National Flag - Give reasons for naming Mauritius ‘the Star & Key of the Indian Ocean’
Historical Skills*	Our Cultural Heritage	- Examine the different features of the Coat of Arms of Mauritius and Rodrigues - Discuss the significance of the different colours of our National Flag • Appreciate the need to protect important historical buildings and monuments of our country - identify places of historical interest in the country (Mauritius & Rodrigues) - explain the importance of these historical sites and the need to preserve them

*The content provides opportunities to develop in learners historical inquiry and historical skills. Values, attitudes, respect for cultural heritage and civic responsibility are addressed in conjunction with relevant Historical themes.

ACHIEVEMENT CRITERIA AND LEVELS

Achievement criteria are assessment objectives that are scaffolded and represent clear measurable outcomes. The levels reflect the competencies in terms of knowledge, skills, values and attitudes expected of pupils. The criteria move progressively from Level 1 (basic competency) to Level 3.

LEARNING OUTCOMES, ACHIEVEMENT CRITERIA AND LEVELS FOR GRADE 3, 4, 5 AND 6

	TOPIC	LEARNING OUTCOME	LEVEL 1	LEVEL 2	LEVEL 3
GRADE 3	Myself & My Family	Show basic understanding of past and present	1. Distinguish between past and present	1. Distinguish between past and present using appropriate vocabulary	1. Distinguish between past and present using appropriate vocabulary and examples
			2. Tell personal information (name, age, address) about himself/herself	2. Tell and write information (name, age, address) about himself/herself	2. Explore and record information (personal dates and events - age, birthday, first day at school) about himself/herself and family
		Show awareness of time and change	3. Put events in their own life in temporal order	3. Show an understanding of chronology through exploring events in their own life in simple sequences	3. Demonstrate an understanding of chronology through exploring and recording of events in sequences on a timeline
			4. Identify family members living with them	4. Identify and name family members living with them	4. Identify, name and compare relative ages of family members living with them and caring for them
			5. Examine simple evidence	5. Collect and examine simple evidence	5. Collect, examine and discuss simple evidence
			6. Identify changes in himself/herself	6. Identify and communicate changes in himself/herself	6. Identify and communicate changes by comparing photographs, clothes worn or toys used at different ages, noting development and things that have remained the same
	My Locality	Show an awareness of space, time, change and development	7. Identify features in the locality	7. Identify changes in the features in the locality	7. Compare features in the locality
			8. Name features in the locality	8. Show features of the locality on a map or diagram.	8. Draw diagrams and describe the features of the locality
			9. Name a few buildings in the locality	9. Name and differentiate between old and new buildings in the locality	9. Name, draw and compare buildings in the locality
			10. Identify changes in the locality	10. identify and name changes in the locality	10. Discuss changes in the locality
			11. Identify clean and dirty localities	11. Show an awareness of how to keep the locality clean	11. Suggest examples of how to keep the locality clean.

GRADE 4	Locality Past & Present	Demonstrate an understanding of change and continuity by exploring similarities and differences between past and present	1. Identify types of locality	1. Identify and name types of locality	1. Identify, name and describe types of locality
	People living in the locality: Our community	Develop an understanding of time and chronology	2. Identify changes in the locality	2. Identify and name changes in the locality	2. Identify, name and discuss changes in the locality
			3. Identify old and new buildings in the locality	3. Describe the old and new buildings in the locality	3. Compare the buildings and discuss their purpose
			4. Identify old pictures, photographs, objects used in the past	4. Identify and describe old pictures, photographs, objects used in the past	4. Identify, describe and compare old pictures, photographs, objects used in the past
	Voyages of Discovery	Develop ability to use evidence to understand the past	5. Identify people living in the locality	5. Describe the ways of living of people in the locality (food, clothing, jobs, festivals)	5. Compare, discuss and show appreciation of different people living in the locality
		Demonstrate an appreciation of our cultural diversity (e.g. food, clothing and ways of life)	6. Name countries trading in the Indian Ocean	6. Name and locate on a map countries trading in the Indian Ocean	6. Discuss reasons why countries traded in the Indian Ocean
			7. Name plants and animals on the island before the arrival of humans	7. Describe changes on the island with the arrival of human beings	7. Discuss the consequences on the fauna and flora with the arrival of human beings
			8. Locate and mark on a map nature reserves in the island	8. Discuss the purpose of nature reserves	8. Recognize and discuss the importance of nature reserves in the preservation of fauna and flora
		Realise how Mauritius and Rodrigues were before human beings came			

Grade 5	Discovery of Mauritius	Show an understanding of how Mauritius was when discovered	1. Name the countries that visited Mauritius in the past	1. Give reasons why the countries visited Mauritius	1. Discuss reasons for trade and exploration in the Indian Ocean and Mauritius in the 15th century
	Settlement in Mauritius & Rodrigues		2. Name the Mascarene Islands	2. Name, locate and show on a map the Mascarene Islands	2. Explore the discovery of the Mascarene Islands by the Portuguese and the Dutch
			Beginning of Settlement in Mauritius & Rodrigues	3. List reasons for making settlement in a place	3. Describe the activities of the Dutch settlers in the south-east of the island & the settlement of François Leguat in Rodrigues
		4. Give reasons for the French settlement in the island		4. Describe the activities of French settlers in the island	4. Compare the Dutch settlement with the French settlement in the island
		Activities of Settlers: Trade and Agriculture	5. Name some of the crops cultivated in the island and name the countries from where they were brought	5. Give reasons for developing agriculture in the island	5. Discuss how Labourdonnais and Pierre Poivre developed agriculture in the Island
			Examine the importance of Port Louis in the history of the country	6. Give reasons why the British decided to conquer Ile de France	6. Describe the Battle of Grand Port
		7. Name the French governor who made Port Louis the capital of Ile de France		7. Explain why the French shifted the capital to Port Louis	7. Explain how Labourdonnais developed the harbour and town of Port Louis
		8. Identify changes in the island due to the settlement made by the Europeans (Dutch, French and British)		8. Describe the changes in the island as a result of the European(Dutch, French and British settlement)	8. Explain the consequences of the settlement on the development of trade and agriculture in the island
	9. Identify and name a few buildings in Port-Louis	9. Explain the purpose of the buildings		9. Discuss the importance of Port Louis in the development of trade and commerce in the island	
	Port Louis : the Capital of Mauritius	10. Identify pictures and photographs of the island and Port Louis in the past	10. Identify and interpret pictures and photographs of the island and of Port Louis in the past	10. Interpret and compare pictures, photographs of the island and Port Louis in the past and discuss changes	

Grade 6	People on the Island in the past: Settlers, Slaves & Immigrants	Develop an understanding of the social and cultural life of the people on the island before independence	1. Identify and locate on the map places from where the settlers, slaves and the immigrants (Indian & Chinese) came to the island	1. Explain the terms settlers, slaves and immigrants	1. Discuss the reasons for bringing slaves and immigrants in the island
	Celebrating Independence	Appreciate the significance of the national symbols	2. List the activities of the slaves and immigrants on the island	2. Describe the living and working conditions of the slaves and immigrants on the island	2. Discuss the contributions of the slaves and immigrants in the development of the island
	Our Cultural Heritage	Appreciate the need to protect important historical buildings and monuments of our country	3. Identify the different features of the Coats of Arms (Mauritius & Rodrigues)	3. Examine the different features of the Coats of Arms (Mauritius & Rodrigues)	3. Discuss reasons for naming Mauritius the 'Star & key of the Indian Ocean'
			4. Identify the different colours of the national flag	4. Explain the significance of the colours of the national flag	4. Discuss the significance of the national symbols flag, flower, Coat of Arms) in developing a sense of belonging to the nation
			5. Identify places of historical interest in the country (Mauritius & Rodrigues)	5. Describe the importance of the places of historical importance in the country (Mauritius & Rodrigues)	5. Discuss the need to preserve the historical sites in the country (Mauritius & Rodrigues)

